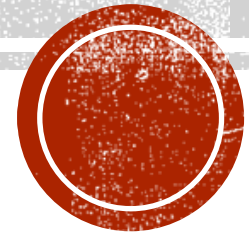


UNIT - 2

CONCEPT OF KOSHTHA(PART – II)



INTRODUCTION

- The word **Koshtha** is used for the vast empty place where the things can be kept in a lot.
- In our thoracic and abdominal cavities a lot of vacant place is available where all the organs are arranged properly.
- As per Sushruta entire abdomen should be considered as Koshtha.
- According to Sushruta,
- Thoraco – abdominal cavity can be considered as the Koshtha where stomach, large intestine, small intestine , blood, appendix, lungs, etc organs are located.
- The koshtha is not just a alimentary canal but includes all connected organs also such as Gallbladder, Pancreas etc.
- Bringing the dosha to koshtha means – the bio-waste components or residuals are transported to GIT for elimination.



TYPES OF KOSHTHA

- About the Koshtha (name of alimentary tract)
- Koshtha is of 3 types :

1. **Krura (hard)**
2. **Mridu (soft)**
3. **Madhyam (moderate, medium)**

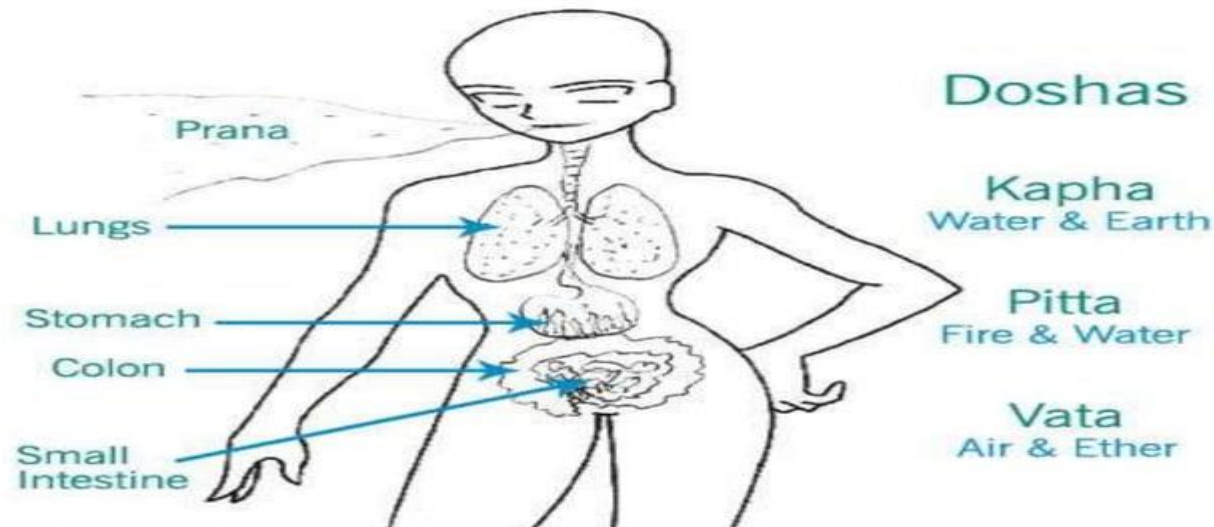
Vata means space and air that governs the movement, pitta (fire and water) regulates metabolism , and kapha (earth and water) manages assimilation in the body.

- In the context Sharngadhara has mentioned that –
- The person having pitta predominance in their constitutions, due to predominance of pitta or increase of pitta causes watery or semisolid faces, moving out more than once or twice a day known as Mridu Koshtha (soften stools).
- The person having kapha predominance in constitutions, due to predominance or increase of kapha causes soft. Solod, faces moving out smoothly once a day or regularly known as madhyam koshtha (semisolid stools).
- The person having vata predominant in constitution , due to predominance or increase vata produce very hard faces or constipation. This type of koshtha is known as Krura Koshtha (difficult to digest).



THERAPEUTIC TEST FOR DIAGNOSIS BOWELS

- The person with laxed bowels is properly oleated by taking unctuous substances of three consecutive nights with following drugs such as –
- Sugarcandy, sugarcane juice, milk, milkcream from the curd, payasa, gruel made from tila, rice, masha , ghee, juice of kasamarda, amalaka, and even hot water.
- Intake of any of these serves as purgative of those with Mridu Koshta (laxed bowels) because their Grahani (duodenum including small intestine) is too much dominated by pitta.



CLINICAL SIGNIFICANCE OF KOSHTHA

CLINICAL SIGNIFICANCE OF KOSHTHA

- The examination of koshtha is Necessary for the following like –
- Since five cleansing procedure are inevitable (unavoidable) in case of vitiation of dosha
- Snehana and Swedana are inevitable pre - operative procedures before performing the cleansing ones.
- This reveals the predominance of dosha and makes the physician to judge the line of diet can be decided as diet is supposed to be one of the lines of treatment .
- For Snehana which unctuous material should be used is decided
- Dose and drug of choice of emetics and purgatives can be decided



The five panchakarma procedures are:

- **Vamana**: It is an emesis, in which an individual is made to vomit after being stimulated with certain medicines. It helps to treat disorders such as skin diseases, gynaecological issues, hypothyroidism, diabetes mellitus, obesity and initial stages of liver diseases.
- **Virechanam**: It is a purgation technique, in which a certain drug is prescribed as a purgative. The body is stimulated to remove toxins through the anal route, thus clearing the metabolic pathways to function better. It is generally done in pitta disorders such as blood-related issues, infective skin problems, liver diseases, psychological disturbances, and preconception care.
- **Kashaya Vasthi**: In this, different drugs are mixed according to the clinical condition and administered using a vasthi yantra (the enema instrument).
- **Sneha Vasthi**: A form of enema, in which medicated oils are used in the vasthi, it is always done in combination with kashaya vasthi. It helps to cure disorders such as those pertaining to the musculoskeletal system, neurological conditions and endocrine issues.
- **Nasyam**: A treatment where herbal oils, juices, or powder are instilled through the nasal route, it is generally done in (issues pertaining to the above-shoulder region).

